Apex Systems Pvt. Ltd.

Proposal in response to **MRG-RFP-2026-014**: Omnichannel Customer Service & Ticketing Platform
Submitted to: Meridian Retail Group (fictional)
Submission date: 2026-09-22 | Proposal validity: 120 days
Contact: Rohan Mehta, Bid Director (rohan.mehta@apexsystems.example)

Synthetic document created for a classroom exercise. All companies, people, clients and figures are fictional.

1. Executive Summary

Meridian Retail Group operates 140 stores and an e-commerce site across India and has issued MRG-RFP-2026-014 to replace its legacy email-based support desk with a cloud omnichannel platform covering email, web chat, WhatsApp and voice callback. Key requirements are integration with the existing SAP S/4HANA order system and Salesforce loyalty CRM, support for 350 agents (peak 600 in festive season), go-live within 6 months, data residency in India, and DPDP Act 2023 compliance.

Apex Systems proposes **ApexServe Enterprise**, a microservices-based contact centre platform hosted on AWS Mumbai (ap-south-1) with a hot standby in AWS Hyderabad (ap-south-2). Our design prioritises scalability, security and clean integration. We have deliberately priced for a premium, fully redundant architecture rather than a minimum-viable deployment.

2. Proposed Solution and Technical Architecture

ApexServe is built as 22 containerised services on Kubernetes (EKS) with an event bus (Kafka) that decouples channels from the ticketing core. Each channel adapter scales independently; load tests in our lab sustained 1,200 concurrent agents and 9,000 messages per minute with p95 latency of 340 ms.

- **SAP S/4HANA integration:** certified SAP BTP connector using OData v4 for order lookup, returns and refund status; bidirectional, near real-time (under 5 seconds).
- **Salesforce integration:** MuleSoft-free native connector using Salesforce Platform Events; loyalty tier and lifetime value shown on every ticket.
- **Channels:** email, web chat widget, WhatsApp Business API (Meta BSP partner), voice callback via Exotel.
- **AI assist:** intent classification and reply suggestions; models hosted in-region, no customer data used for training.
- **Auto-scaling:** horizontal pod autoscaling sized for the 600-agent festive peak, with pre-warming two weeks before Diwali.

3. Implementation Approach

We follow a four-phase approach: Discover, Build, Migrate, Hypercare. Delivery is planned at **24 weeks**, which meets the 6-month window but leaves limited float. Our critical-path risk is SAP connector testing, which depends on Meridian providing a sandbox by Week 4.

Milestone	Week	Deliverable
M1 Discovery & design sign-off	4	Solution design document, integration specs
M2 Core platform + email/chat	10	Tenant built, SSO, routing rules
M3 SAP & Salesforce integrations	15	Tested connectors, UAT scripts
M4 WhatsApp + voice, data migration	19	2.1 million legacy tickets migrated
M5 Pilot (20 stores) and UAT	22	Pilot report, defect closure
M6 Go-live and hypercare	24	Production cutover, 4-week hypercare

Team: 1 programme manager, 1 solution architect, 2 integration engineers (SAP certified), 3 platform engineers, 1 security lead, 2 QA, 1 change-management lead (11 FTE).

4. Commercial Proposal

Item	Basis	Amount (INR)
Platform licence (350 agents)	Rs 2,600 per agent/month x 12	1,09,20,000
Festive burst licences (250 agents x 3 months)	Rs 2,600 per agent/month	19,50,000
Implementation & integration services	Fixed price	86,00,000
Data migration	Fixed price	14,00,000
Premium support (24x7, named TAM)	Annual	22,00,000
Total Year 1		**2,50,70,000**
Estimated Year 2 and 3 (each)	Licences + support, 5% uplift cap	**1,58,23,500**

Assumptions: prices exclude GST; Meridian supplies SAP and Salesforce sandboxes; WhatsApp conversation charges billed at Meta cost with no markup; travel included for Mumbai and Bengaluru only. Three-year total cost of ownership: approximately Rs 5.67 crore.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 and ISO/IEC 27701 certified (certificates valid to 2028); SOC 2 Type II report for FY2025-26 available under NDA.
- All data stored and processed in India; encryption AES-256 at rest, TLS 1.3 in transit; customer-managed keys via AWS KMS optional.
- DPDP Act 2023: consent logging, data principal request workflow, configurable retention and automated purge; breach notification runbook within 72 hours of detection.
- Role-based access, SSO via Azure AD/SAML, immutable audit log retained 7 years.
- Quarterly external penetration test (CERT-In empanelled auditor); RPO 15 minutes, RTO 2 hours.

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
SAP sandbox delayed	Medium	Mock services from Week 2; escalation at steering committee
Festive peak overload	Low	Pre-scaling, load test at 1.5x expected peak
Agent adoption	Medium	Train-the-trainer, 30 super-users, in-app guides

6. Support Model, Experience and References

24x7 L1/L2 support with a named Technical Account Manager; P1 response 15 minutes, resolution target 4 hours; 99.95% monthly uptime SLA with service credits. Apex has delivered 9 contact-centre platforms since 2019, including 3 in retail.

- **Kavya Fashion Retail** (fictional) - 420 agents, SAP integration, live 2024.
- **Northline Electronics** (fictional) - 260 agents, WhatsApp + voice, live 2025.
- References available on request after shortlisting.